

# Character.AI and Similar Apps & Environmental Impact

Posted by u/mintleafz • 0 points • 7 comments

I've been thinking about this for a good while.

How do you guys feel about AI being used for apps where people can “talk” to their favorite characters? I think this is honestly one of the most wasteful apps besides the AI art programs. Apart from taking away from the art of fanfiction, it also leads to unnecessary wasting of water to cool the ever-growing server centers that store the data for the several iterations of every single character one can think of. Thoughts?

## Comments

u/JeremiahTDK • 1 points • 2025-09-20 20:10 UTC

Programs like Character.AI and Chai fall into a sort of gray zone for me. I was introduced to the former by my boyfriend and the latter by a close friend of mine. But I quit using them because I became aware of their environmental impact. I haven't used either in... I think a month.

But now that I'm thinking seriously about it, I can see how these might be harmful, especially for a writer. I am one myself. It's why I started toying around with these, to explore my ideas. (I occasionally explored some other users' ideas, and some were really good.)

I fell in love with the idea of talking to my OCs and my favorite characters. The more freedom I had to explore those concepts, the more I liked it. But after a while, it just didn't feel as pleasurable anymore. My old ideas no longer satisfied me, and the responses strayed too far from the characters and the narratives I started. I started jumping between different AIs so I wouldn't get bored.

I think this is how it can be harmful. Because it gives you a euphoria that never lasts. You lose interest in even your own ideas, and I hate that. It's almost like when I used Grammarly — I hate that program to this day. Yet I don't hate Character.AI or Chai.

For all of their flaws, I do see some recreational potential in them. I just don't want them harming the planet or reducing our ability to feel pleasure from our own imaginations. I would want these to be fixed in a way that reduces both risks at once.

u/Adventurous\_Ear7814 • 1 points • 2025-09-04 10:45 UTC

I genuinely don't think it takes away from the art of fanfiction, as a fanfiction writer myself, but I am learning about its harm to the environment

u/Moonshot\_Decidueye • 1 points • 2025-05-25 06:44 UTC

C.ai, as shitty as it is, isn't bad for the environment because it doesn't make images

u/Capital\_Pension5814 • 1 points • 2025-05-25 22:20 UTC

Yea that is true, image generation requires an iteration for each pixel. But you could probably save that by turning off your AC for at most an hours. If you have a big c.ai chat its similar in generation to image ai though

**u/ClassicTechnology202** • 3 points • 2025-05-25 03:36 UTC

I used to use character ai. im honestly ashamed to admit it, but i haven't used it for a few weeks now, and I dont plan on starting again.

**u/miifanatic\_1788** • 1 points • 2025-05-27 15:54 UTC

Same, a friend got me into it and I remember having so much fun using until I started noticing how much the chat bot would constantly repeat things and anything mildly inappropriate would get me a warning, I'm kinda glad for that as it made me delete my account and uninstall the app entirely. Fuck character. Ai

**u/[deleted]** • 1 points • 2025-05-25 00:39 UTC

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**u/Maiq-the-Liar123** • 1 points • 2025-08-28 23:14 UTC

Why the hell did I decide to click that link? I'm so fucking stupid.

**u/Weary-Animator-2646** • 1 points • 2025-05-24 18:48 UTC

In general the water usage issue is overblown as it's largely just a closed loop, all servers use water, including the one you're using right now by using Reddit.

**u/Capital\_Pension5814** • 2 points • 2025-05-25 22:22 UTC

Truly, Reddit servers use as much energy as ai (currently though tbh)

**u/TheHellAmISupposed2B** • 2 points • 2025-05-24 19:16 UTC

Also, storage isn't even a factor of the energy use. The storage of data is just not where the energy usage of ai is from.

It takes like, a single watt hour to store a terabyte, at most.